

BRENNERI

COMMON

BRENNERI

HUMANOID

Brenneri trace their ancestry to the coastal shelves, floating districts, and submerged settlements of **Wander**. Their large eyes, sensitive hearing, expressive whiskers, and constant awareness of nearby emotions have given them a reputation for friendliness, caution, and social anxiety. Brenneri can often sense a conflict developing before anyone speaks, though sensing that something is wrong does not necessarily tell them why.

During early development, most brenneri form a powerful attachment to a particular inanimate object. This object, commonly a smooth stone, shell, piece of glass, worn tool component, or fragment of Wander material, becomes known as the brenneri's **anchor**. Its familiar weight, texture, scent, and temperature provide a stable sensory reference when the emotions around them become difficult to separate from their own.

Erbium Industries classifies anchors as **affective stabilization articles**. Under Settled Systems Code **A4%7&6-2**, employers may place an anchor into secure custodial retention for the duration of designated service. The policy is presented as a way to protect irreplaceable objects from workplace hazards, prevent emotional dependency, and encourage independent regulation. In practice, access to an anchor is often used as a performance incentive, disciplinary tool, and guarantee that a brenneri will complete their assigned service.

Brenneri are frequently directed toward diplomacy, customer relations, grievance management, first contact, medical intake, and **Ancestry Resources**. Their whiskers make them effective at recognizing distress, concealed hostility, fear, and sudden changes in group morale. Erbium training teaches brenneri to convert those sensations into reports, productivity interventions, and conflict assessments useful to management.

A brenneri might spend their career calming workers whose problems they have no authority to solve. Those who eventually receive their anchors back often do so late in life, after fulfilling a service obligation that defined most of their adulthood.

If you want to play an emotionally perceptive character who keeps others afloat while struggling against a society that treats empathy as a labor resource, you should play a brenneri.



YOU MIGHT...

- ◆ Sense tension before anyone openly acknowledges that something is wrong.
- ◆ Carry a replica or unauthorized substitute for the anchor held by your employer.
- ◆ Feel responsible for resolving conflicts even when neither side will listen to you.
- ◆ Use your empathy to protect distressed workers from management rather than reporting them.
- ◆ Collect smooth stones, shells, machine parts, or other objects that provide familiar sensory comfort.
- ◆ Resent being treated as agreeable, harmless, or naturally suited to emotional labor.

OTHERS PROBABLY...

- ◆ Expect you to mediate arguments regardless of your actual occupation.
- ◆ Assume your whiskers tell you exactly what everyone is thinking.
- ◆ Treat your anxiety as endearing rather than taking it seriously.
- ◆ Mistake your caution for weakness or indecision.
- ◆ Distrust you as a possible Ancestry Resources informant or corporate mood monitor.
- ◆ Regard your attachment to an anchor as childish, irrational, or evidence of dependency.

PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION

Brenneris are bipedal, otter-like humanoids who average approximately 5 feet in height and usually possess slight, compact builds. Their short, dense fur can vary considerably in color, though shades of brown, gray, cream, black, rust, and muted gold are common. Many have lighter fur along the muzzle, throat, chest, abdomen, or inner limbs.

Their webbed hands and feet end in short claws suited to swimming, climbing wet surfaces, and handling objects. A thick, muscular tail provides propulsion and balance in water. Brenneris can hold their breath for extended periods, but they are air-breathing mammals and cannot survive indefinitely underwater without environmental equipment.

Large, round eyes allow brenneris to detect movement and danger under poor lighting conditions. Their hearing extends beyond the ordinary range of many other ancestries, allowing them to perceive distant machinery, structural vibration, infrasonic calls, and subtle changes in breathing or speech.

A brenneri's whiskers are particularly sensitive. They respond to pheromones, electromagnetic activity, air movement, and other physical changes associated with nearby emotional states. Strong fear, anger, grief, or agitation can produce a sensation that is difficult for the brenneri to ignore. The experience does not provide direct access to another person's thoughts, intentions, or memories. It is closer to feeling the pressure of an emotion without necessarily knowing its cause.

This sensitivity frequently produces hypervigilance. Brenneris monitor tone, posture, breathing, movement, and environmental changes almost constantly. Many use deliberate breathing exercises, repetitive movements, touch, familiar scents, or a bonded anchor to distinguish their own emotional state from those around them.

Brenneris possess naturally water-resistant pouches beneath their arms. Historically, these protected food, small tools, shells, and anchors from saltwater and rough currents. Modern workwear often incorporates access panels or protective compartments around these pouches, although standardized Erbium uniforms do not always accommodate them comfortably.

SOCIETY

Brenneri culture developed around the understanding that no individual remains stable entirely alone. Traditional communities describe themselves as **rafts**, small networks of relatives, partners, friends, dependents, and trusted neighbors who share practical and emotional responsibility for one another.

The term comes from an emergency survival practice used in Wander's flooded regions. Brenneris would link limbs and tails while floating together, creating a stable mass around children, injured adults, exhausted swimmers, and anyone unable to remain above water alone. Modern rafts may have no direct connection to water, but the principle remains: those with strength support those without it until circumstances change.

A raft is rarely organized around one permanent leader. Different members take responsibility according to their skills and condition. A brenneri who provides emotional support during one crisis may depend completely on the same community during another. This expectation of reciprocal care can clash sharply with Settled Systems institutions, which assign responsibility according to employment title, eligibility, and contractual obligation.

Brenneri children commonly choose or encounter an anchor during early development. The object is not selected for monetary value. Its importance grows through repeated use during fear, confusion, illness, emotional overload, or separation from caregivers. The anchor becomes associated with safety and with the brenneri's ability to recognize their own emotional baseline.

The destruction of Wander intensified the cultural importance of these objects. Many surviving anchors are among the few personal items carried away from lost communities. A chipped stone or mineral-smoothed machine bearing may be an ordinary object to everyone else and the last surviving physical connection to a brenneri's family district.

Brenneris teach strict etiquette around their emotional senses. Sensing distress does not grant permission to question, diagnose, expose, touch, or report another person. A brenneri is expected to acknowledge uncertainty and distinguish between what their whiskers detect and what they merely assume.

Erbium Industries teaches a different standard. Corporate brenneri are trained to document emotional irregularities, identify deteriorating morale, predict workplace conflict, and escalate perceived risks to management. In Ancestry Resources, brenneris may conduct disciplinary meetings, grievance intake, bereavement notification, settlement integration, and labor mediation.

Some brenneris consider these occupations a legitimate extension of their cultural responsibility to reduce harm. Others argue that Erbium uses their empathy to make exploitation more tolerable without addressing its causes. A brenneri mediator may be praised for calming an angry extraction crew while the unsafe quota that caused the anger remains unchanged.

Brenneris outside corporate systems maintain anchor exchanges, emotional-support networks, and informal rafts for workers separated from their communities. Some conceal anchors that were supposed to be surrendered at the beginning of service. Others maintain counterfeit custody records or arrange brief unauthorized reunions between workers and the objects Erbium holds over them.

BELIEFS

Brenneris practice many religions and philosophies, but the image of the raft appears throughout their spiritual and civic traditions. A community is judged by whom it keeps above water when survival becomes difficult.

Many brenneris interpret **the Star Dream** as the largest shared emotional experience in known history. Peoples on distant worlds received the same revelation and were moved to seek one another despite having no prior relationship. To some brenneris, this suggests that connection is a fundamental property of sapient life. Others reject that interpretation, particularly when the doctrine of the Elect is used to deny dignity to those who never experienced the Dream.

Brenneri ethics frequently distinguish between recognizing an emotion and claiming authority over it. Their senses may reveal that someone is afraid, furious, or grieving, but the person experiencing that emotion retains the right to define its meaning.

Anchor custody has become a major religious and cultural dispute. Erbium-approved authorities argue that temporary separation develops resilience and protects valuable objects. Many brenneris consider involuntary separation a deliberate disruption of a formative bond. Destroying, withholding, or threatening another person's anchor is widely treated as an act of intimate coercion.

Popular Edicts keep vulnerable people afloat, listen before interpreting another person's emotions, protect another person's anchor, de-escalate conflict without concealing its cause, contribute to the raft when you are able

Popular Anathema weaponize knowledge of another person's emotions, destroy or withhold an anchor to compel obedience, force someone to mediate a conflict, abandon a dependent during danger, claim certainty about feelings you have only partially sensed

SAMPLE NAMES

Algo, Dako “Bluepaw,” Krill, Ont, Preen “Cardsniff,” Seldi, Shine, Zinks

Brenneri names are often short and easy to pronounce across different vocal structures. Many adopt nicknames based on hobbies, habits, occupations, physical traits, or personal collections.

OTHER INFORMATION

ANCHOR CUSTODY

Settled Systems Code **A4%7&6-2**, formally titled the **Personal Stabilization Article Custodial Accommodation**, permits designated employers and civic-service authorities to retain objects identified as necessary to an employee’s emotional regulation.

The provision is ancestry-neutral, but it is applied most extensively to brenneri anchors.

Erbium Industries publicly claims that custody:

- ◆ protects irreplaceable anchors from industrial damage;
- ◆ prevents loss during deployment;
- ◆ reduces distraction;
- ◆ encourages independent coping skills;
- ◆ allows professional monitoring of unhealthy dependency;
- ◆ ensures that emotional-support objects do not interfere with required equipment.

At the beginning of designated service, a brenneri’s anchor is catalogued, scanned, assigned an asset-storage record, and transferred to an approved retention facility. The brenneri may receive a visual replica, material substitute, or digital record of the object. These replacements rarely reproduce the accumulated sensory familiarity of the original.

Supervised access may be granted during:

- ◆ clinical stabilization;
- ◆ approved bereavement;
- ◆ performance rehabilitation;
- ◆ contract renewal;
- ◆ major service milestones;
- ◆ management-authorized incentive periods.

The anchor is scheduled for return when the brenneri completes every qualifying service obligation. Outstanding equipment debt, unresolved housing charges, continuity disputes, civic-service assignments, and disciplinary reviews can delay release.

When a brenneri dies before release, the anchor is supposed to pass to a designated raft member or beneficiary. Storage fees, inheritance disputes, and corporate property claims frequently prevent that transfer.

Your anchor is not being taken from you.

It is being protected until you are prepared to carry it without dependency.

~ Erbium Employee Wellness Services

ANCESTRY RESOURCES

Ancestry Resources is the collection of Erbium departments responsible for workplace integration among different ancestries. Its stated responsibilities include accommodation, communication, conflict resolution, cultural orientation, accessibility, and employee welfare.

Brenneris are disproportionately employed as:

- ◆ grievance coordinators;
- ◆ settlement liaisons;
- ◆ first-contact assistants;
- ◆ morale assessors;
- ◆ disciplinary witnesses;
- ◆ bereavement officers;
- ◆ client-relations personnel;
- ◆ labor mediators;
- ◆ emotional-risk monitors.

Their reports are often treated as objective assessments despite being interpretations of emotional signals rather than direct knowledge. A brenneri who senses fear during an investigation may be pressured to identify deception. One who senses anger during organizing activity may be required to report a potential security escalation.

Workers may therefore distrust corporate brenneris even when the brenneri is attempting to help them. Some Ancestry Resources employees falsify assessments, omit private information, or classify justified anger as ordinary occupational stress to protect their coworkers.

RAFTS BEYOND WANDER

The loss of Wander scattered brenneri communities across the Settled Systems. Many modern rafts consist of unrelated workers, refugees, neighbors, and traveling companions who have agreed to provide mutual support.

A raft may pool housing, medical costs, legal representation, and transportation credits. Members may preserve one another's anchors, maintain independent emotional records, or provide testimony when corporate assessments contradict a brenneri's own account of their mental state.

Erbium recognizes some rafts as household units when doing so simplifies housing and benefit administration. The company can also classify a raft as an unlicensed financial association, unauthorized care provider, or source of coordinated workplace interference.

BRENNERI MECHANICS

HIT POINTS

8

SIZE

Medium

SPEED

25 feet

Swim 20 feet

ATTRIBUTE BOOSTS

Constitution, Charisma, Free

ATTRIBUTE FLAW

Strength

LANGUAGES

Common

Brenneri

Additional languages equal to your Intelligence modifier, if it is positive. Choose from the list of common languages and any other languages to which you have access, such as languages prevalent on your home world.

DARKVISION

You can see in darkness and dim light just as well as you can see in bright light, though your vision in darkness is in black and white.

EMPATHETIC WHISKERS

Your whiskers continuously sense the emotions of those around you, which makes you susceptible to mirroring their feelings. You have a +2 circumstance bonus to Sense Motive checks regarding the emotional state of an adjacent creature. You take a -1 circumstance penalty to Will saves against **emotion** effects. When you end your turn adjacent to an ally with the **frightened** condition, you must attempt a DC 5 flat check. On a failure, you become frightened 1.

BREATH CONTROL

You gain the **Breath Control** general feat.

Heritages

AMBASSADOR BRENNERI

You excelled in your teenage mediation training and were selected for service as a member of the famed **Ancestry Resources: Ambassadorship Branch**. You become trained in Diplomacy. If you would automatically become trained in Diplomacy (from your background or class, for example), you instead become trained in a skill of your choice.

As an ambassador, you learned how to work in close partnership with your allies. You train one non-minion willing ally to be your ambassador partner by spending 1 week of downtime training with them. You can have only one ambassador partner at a time. If you train a new ambassador partner, they replace your previous ambassador partner. You and your ambassador partner gain the Pardon Me action.

Pardon Me

PARDON ME ↻

FORTUNE

Source *Galactic Ancestries* pg. 94

Frequency once per day

Trigger Your ambassador partner fails (but does not critically fail) a Diplomacy check to Make an Impression

You attempt a Diplomacy check to Make an Impression. Your ambassador partner uses your result for the triggering Diplomacy check instead (even if it's lower).

BIOLUMINESCENT BRENNERI

You are descended from members of a community that lives in a network of sea caves where the sun doesn't reach. Other life in these caves, such as the winged murzzilats, barrel through the tight spaces at incredible speed. Injury from unintended collisions is so common that many beings who live in the chasms have evolved to emit light as a warning.

Your fur is made up of specialized fibers that absorb light from fluorescent algae. You can make your fur glow with bioluminescence or pat it down to stop glowing with an **Interact** action. When you glow, you shed bright light in a 20- foot radius (and dim light for the next 20 feet).

You are not **off-guard** while in water, and you don't take the usual penalties for using a bludgeoning or slashing melee weapon in water, or to ranged attacks made underwater or against an underwater enemy.

CLAWED BRENNERI

You are a particularly muscular brenneri with pronounced claws, standing out as a potential defender or soldier among your pod. You can pry open oysters or crabs with ease, and your claws are robust enough to serve as a natural defense. Additionally, you become trained in **Athletics**. If you would automatically become trained in Athletics (from your background or class, for example), you instead become trained in a skill of your choice. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus on Athletics checks to **Force Open**, and you gain the **Ancestral Unarmed Attack** (claw, 1d6 slashing [agile, finesse, unarmed], brawling weapon group) ancestry feat.

POD BRENNERI

You are tightly bonded to a pod and are particularly attuned to their emotions. Your pod consists of a number of willing allies equal to your level, selected when you make your daily preparations.

As long as you're within 100 feet of a member of your pod, you're aware if they are **confused**, **controlled**, **frightened**, or otherwise under the effects of an effect with the **emotion** or **mental** trait. You receive no information beyond the presence or absence of an effect.

You also gain the Empathic Assistance action.

Empathic Assistance

EMPATHIC ASSISTANCE ➡

| **EMOTION** **MENTAL**

Source *Galactic Ancestries* pg. 94

Requirements You are adjacent to a willing member of your pod who is currently frightened or affected by a harmful effect with the emotion or mental trait

You hold your affected pod member's hand to comfort them. If they are frightened, reduce their frightened condition by 1. If they are under the effect of an ongoing emotion or mental effect, attempt a counteract check against the triggering effect, using half your level rounded up as your counteract rank and your Perception modifier as the counteract modifier. On a success, you gain the effect for its remaining duration, and that pod member becomes immune to Empathetic Assistance for 1 hour.

REEF BRENNERI

In shallower waters, reefs create pockets of dense habitation. The crowding of different fish, invertebrates, and plants means that space is a luxury. You are adapted to tight conditions, as well as the highly social web of relationships that characterizes the reefs.

You're shorter than most brenneris and your large, wet eyes never quite matured past a childlike state. Despite your juvenile looks, you are an adult with considerable experience and expertise. Your size is Small instead of Medium. You gain the Big Wet Eye Blink reaction.

Big Wet Eye Blink

BIG WET EYE BLINK

| EMOTION MENTAL VISUAL

Source [Galactic Ancestries pg. 95](#)

Frequency once per day

Trigger A creature you're aware of critically succeeds on a Strike against you and would deal damage to you

You blink your big wet eyes at the triggering creature, forcing it to pull back on its attack. The attacking creature takes a circumstance penalty to the damage of the triggering Strike equal to your level + 2. This penalty applies after doubling the damage for a critical hit. The attacker is then immune to Big Wet Eye Blink for 24 hours.

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